

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a newspaper article about classes for Mainland students:

Compulsory courtesy classes

China's education ministry has ordered all primary and middle schools to teach students the basics of good manners, both with formal classes and by holding after-class activities.

Courtesy and good manners classes will be conducted for students of different age groups. Primary school students will learn to speak politely, respect the elderly and the customs of ethnic minority groups, observe traffic rules and proper table manners and wear clean clothes.

Middle school students will be taught to hold polite conversations with both Chinese people and foreigners, dress properly and observe etiquette (courtesy rules) on the telephone, in emails, text-messaging and in exchanges of letters, as well as in public venues.

In addition, high school students will master the principles and the art of holding conversation and dressing properly for different occasions, along with etiquette for delivering speeches and debates. They will also learn how to keep the proper distance from other people when they are queuing or using lifts.

The ministry encouraged teachers to diversify and find innovative ways to conduct courtesy education to make it more attractive and effective.

Your group is participating in a discussion on the topic "Should compulsory courtesy classes be introduced in Hong Kong secondary schools?" You may want to talk about:

- whether courtesy classes should be compulsory or not
- what can be taught in courtesy classes
- which age group of students would benefit the most
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Are you polite to everyone?
2. Do people on the MTR show good manners?
3. What do you consider to be rude behaviour?
4. Which is the better place to learn good manners – home or school?
5. How can schools make courtesy classes attractive to students?
6. What would you do if someone was rude to you?
7. Why do we need good manners?
8. Does being courteous mean that you are a good person?